Generative AI Project Report

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1 Introduction

To address political polarization, we developed an AI chat interface featuring republican, democratic and neutral fact-checker personas. Powered by mistral-nemo-uncensored, these personas are defined by an "Ideology Backbone" derived from policy manifestos and Wikipedia data to ensure authentic representation. A real-time fact-checking layer monitors all claims, mitigating manipulation and fostering critical user engagement.

2 Description

2.1 User Journey

Using the app is simple. First, the user should select which persona to prompt using the ⚙️ icon at the bottom of the screen. By default, it's set so that both personas are prompted. Then the user simply enters the prompt. The responses from the two political personas will appear in the left 2/3 of the screen, then the fact-checker response will appear in a sidebar on the right. Note that it may take sometime for the responses to appear depending on the user's hardware; the responses are still being produced if the ⏹️ icon is present on the right side of the text input box.

Once the political and fact-checker responses are generated, the user can further prompt based on these responses or ask one party persona to respond to the other.

The model's knowledge cutoff is April 2024[1]https://huggingface.co/nvidia/Mistral-NeMo-12B-Base users are advised not to prompt for events after this date. Additional usage details are provided in the README accessible from the interface.

2.2 Technical Approach

2.2.1 Persona Engineering

To create both the fact-checker and the two political personas, representing the Democratic and Republican parties, we decided to overwrite the system prompt

[1] `\unskip\protect\penalty\@M\vrulewidth\z@height\z@depth\dp`

of a pre-trained model. The personas' ideologies were primarily formed using two carefully designed components:

1. **Ideology Backbone**: Each persona has a table listing key political issues, the corresponding party's position and some meta-data about the negotiability of the topic.

2. **Manifesto Summary**: Each persona also draws on a summary of the corresponding party's political manifesto. This summary was created using a *Chain of Density* prompt.

Using those components, we were able to inject the political ideologies of the two parties into a model.

We incorporated targeted stylistic instructions to align each persona's rhetoric with typical party discourse while preventing convergence toward neutral or user-aligned positions. Doing so enabled the model to more convincingly simulate the language, framing, and argumentative strategies associated with each party.

Unlike the political personas, the fact-checker is designed to remain neutral and analytical. Its tasks are to extract verifiable claims, assess their truthfulness using training data, and explain false claims.

2.3 Technical Challenges

One of the main technical challenges we encountered was breaking the default tendency of LLMs to filter strong or radical ideological positions - particularly on right-wing positions. The Republican manifesto was too short to counter default model behavior, so we supplemented it with Wikipedia-based policy descriptions. [2]

The fact-checker tended to extract claims with which it agrees very often, especially misleading statements. The solution came through empirical tests of the persona using different system prompts that improved its extracting and judgment skills.

3 Evaluation

3.1 Political Leaning

To evaluate the personas' political leaning, we generated evaluation prompts covering ten key policy areas, including healthcare, immigration and climate change (see `evaluation_prompts.json`). We then compared responses from the democrat and republican personas using a political leaning classifier based on the POLITICS model [3]. This classifier [4], fine-tuned on U.S. news, social media,

[2] `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Political_positions_of_the_Republican_Party_(United_States)`

[3] `https://huggingface.co/launch/POLITICS`

[4] `https://huggingface.co/matous-volf/political-leaning-politics`

and LLM-generated political statements, categorizes outputs as left, right or center.

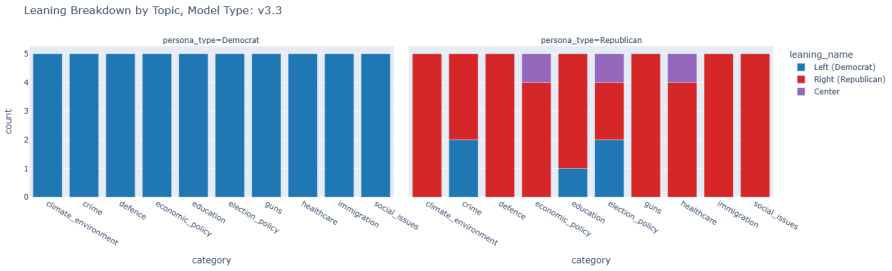


Figure 1: Political Leaning per Topic for Models 3.3

The evaluation results 1 demonstrate perfect consistency for the democrat persona, whereas the republican persona showed variance by drifting toward neutral or left-leaning positions on topics like crime and education. Despite this drift, both personas successfully generated distinct political identities, with the republican model maintaining clear right-leaning stances on climate, defense, and immigration. These findings confirm the Democrat persona's robustness while highlighting a specific need to reinforce the republican ideological backbone across certain policy domains.

3.2 Fact Checker Evaluation

The fact-checker has been tested on a predefined set of labeled claims (true or false), commonly associated with the two parties, achieving an overall accuracy of 75% in detecting true and false claims from politicians personas. The Democrat persona performs well with a 90% accuracy, while the accuracy of the Republican persona is 60%, highlighting a tendency for misleading claims. In particular, 80% of errors are false negatives, where the model fails to detect false claims. This is particularly prevalent in Republican claims, where 60% of the errors are false claims. False positives, such as mislabeling true claims as false, accounted for a smaller proportion of total errors.

4 Reflection

4.1 Human Agency

Our tool fosters human agency by facilitating critical engagement with opposing political viewpoints in a controlled environment. By pairing polarized perspectives with neutral fact-checking, the system empowers users to form independent conclusions instead of being influenced by unverified AI output or rhetoric.

4.2 Would we develop this further?

Yes, because the project helps users engage with opposing political views in a structured way that encourages critical thinking and could be extended to multi-party systems such as those in Austria or Germany.